

able at best. The touch screen is responsive enough, but it's not the smooth, fluid experience you'd get on even the cheapest smartphone. Navigating through your playlists feels functional but clunky. If you've grown used to the snappy UIs of streaming apps, this will feel like a step back.

Battery life is one of the M71's strong points. With up to 56 hours of continuous playback (depending on how you're using it), it's a marathon runner compared to your phone, which probably can go a full day without a charge. That said, using features like Bluetooth or the speaker will drain it faster, so temper your expectations.

The niche factor – Who's this really for?

Here's where things get tricky. The M71 is clearly aimed at a very specific kind of user: someone who doesn't want their music interrupted by notifications, calls, or endless app updates. If you want a distraction-free listening experience, this device gets the job done.

But for the average consumer? It's a harder sell. Why carry a separate device when your smartphone does everything the M71 can – and more? Sure, the sound quality might be better, and the battery life is impressive, but are those benefits worth the extra gadget in your pocket?

There's also the matter of physical storage. While the expandable memory is great, it feels like a relic of an earlier era. In a world dominated by Spotify, YouTube Music, and Apple Music, the idea of painstakingly loading songs onto a device feels like a chore.



Some quirks and odd choices

While the M71 does its job as a music player, some design choices feel a bit puzzling. The dual headphone jacks, for instance, are interesting but niche. Sharing music with a friend feels quaint, but how often is that really happening?

The built-in FM radio is another throwback. It's functional and might appeal to those who still enjoy tuning in to local stations, but let's be real – most people aren't reaching for an FM tuner in 2025.

Video playback feels like the oddest inclusion. On such a small screen, it's hard to see the value, especially when you're likely carrying a smartphone with a much better display.

Is the M71 worth it?

The Audiocular M71 is a charmingly niche product. It's a focused, no-frills device that does what it sets out to do: play music without distractions. For some, that's all it needs to be. The sound quality is solid, the battery life is excellent, and it's refreshingly free from the clutter of modern tech.

But let's not kid ourselves – this is a tough sell in a market dominated by multifunctional smartphones and streaming platforms. The M71 doesn't offer enough to justify itself for most people. It's a device for a very specific audience, and if you're not in that group, you'll probably struggle to see its value.

If you miss the days of carrying a dedicated music player, the M71 might scratch that itch. Just don't expect it to replace your phone anytime soon. **D**

